

AXE CREDIT PORTAL (ACP) — SOFTWARE IMPLEMENTATION & LICENSING CONTRACT

Contract Reference: AXF-ACP-2024-0055 | Date: September 1, 2024 | Confidential

PREAMBLE

This contract governs the licensing, implementation, and support of the Axe Credit Portal (ACP), Axe Finance's flagship end-to-end digital lending platform, for the benefit of the Client. ACP is a multi-segment, AI-powered digital lending solution covering the full credit lifecycle from KYC and onboarding through origination, underwriting, scoring, collateral management, loan servicing, collection, and business intelligence reporting. The parties acknowledge that this engagement represents a strategic digital transformation initiative and commit to full executive sponsorship for the duration of the program.

ARTICLE 1 — PARTIES

Software Provider: Axe Finance SAS, a leading global LendTech company, registered at 4 Rue du Faubourg Saint-Honoré, 75008 Paris, France, SIRET 456 789 123 00021, ISO 27001 certified, represented by Mr. Mehdi Tazi, Chief Executive Officer, and Ms. Nadia Khelil, Chief Delivery Officer. Axe Finance is recognized in the 2024 Gartner Market Guide for Commercial Loan Origination Solutions and positioned as Leader in the 2025 SPARK Matrix for Retail and Commercial Loan Origination Systems.

Client (DAF Representative): BankNorth Africa SA, a commercial bank regulated by the Central Bank of Tunisia, registered at 12 Avenue Habib Bourguiba, 1000 Tunis, Tunisia, SIRET TN-987-654-321, represented by Ms. Fatma Ouertani, Chief Financial Officer (DAF), acting as the authorized signatory on behalf of the Client's executive committee.

Joint Steering Committee: Both parties agree to establish a Steering Committee comprising 3 senior executives from each party, meeting monthly to oversee program delivery, approve changes, and resolve escalations.

ARTICLE 2 — SCOPE OF THE ACP IMPLEMENTATION

Axe Finance shall implement the following ACP modules for BankNorth Africa:

Module	Description	Go-Live Target
ACP KYC & Onboarding	Digital customer onboarding, document collection, identity verification, lead management	Q2 2025
ACP Origination	End-to-end loan origination for Corporate, Commercial and Retail segments	Q3 2025
ACP Scoring & Decisioning	AI-driven credit scoring combining traditional and machine learning models	Q3 2025
ACP Underwriting & Approval	Automated underwriting workflows, approval circuits, and delegation of authority	Q4 2025
ACP Collateral Management	Full collateral lifecycle management, valuation, and monitoring	Q4 2025

ACP Loan Servicing	Post-disbursement loan management, amendments, and restructuring	Q1 2026
ACP Collection & Provisioning	Early warning, collection workflows, and IFRS 9 provisioning	Q2 2026
ACP BI & Reporting	Executive dashboards, regulatory reporting, and performance analytics	Q2 2026
ACP Studio	No-code configuration studio for business rules, workflows, and forms	Q3 2025
ACP Early Warning System	AI-powered credit portfolio monitoring and early risk detection	Q3 2026

The implementation shall follow Axe Finance's proven Agile Implementation Strategy, combining iterative delivery with continuous business validation. All modules are part of the unified ACP platform ensuring seamless data flow across the full credit lifecycle.

ARTICLE 3 — CONTRACT DURATION AND PROGRAM TIMELINE

License Term: Perpetual software license, effective from contract signature.

Implementation Period: 24 months from October 1, 2024 to September 30, 2026.

Support and Maintenance: 5-year initial term (October 2026 – September 2031), renewable annually.

Phase 1 — Foundation (Oct 2024 – Mar 2025): Infrastructure setup, ACP installation, KYC module go-live, data migration strategy, and team onboarding.

Phase 2 — Core Credit Lifecycle (Apr 2025 – Mar 2026): Origination, Scoring, Underwriting, Collateral, and Loan Servicing go-live. Integration with CBS (Core Banking System), CRM, and regulatory reporting systems.

Phase 3 — Advanced Capabilities (Apr 2026 – Sep 2026): Collection, Provisioning, BI Reporting, Early Warning System, AI model tuning, and full organizational embedding.

ARTICLE 4 — FINANCIAL TERMS AND PAYMENT SCHEDULE

Total Contract Value: EUR 1,850,000 excluding VAT

Component	Amount (EUR excl. VAT)	Payment Trigger
ACP Software License — Full Suite	650,000	Contract signature
Phase 1 Implementation	250,000	Phase 1 acceptance
Phase 2 Implementation	450,000	Phase 2 acceptance
Phase 3 Implementation	250,000	Phase 3 acceptance
Year 1 Support & Maintenance	100,000	Go-live date
Year 2-5 Support & Maintenance	90,000/year	Annual renewal
Training Program (120 users)	50,000	Training completion
Data Migration Services	50,000	Migration acceptance

Contingency Reserve (5%)	~90,000	As approved by Steering Committee
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All invoices are payable within 45 days of receipt. Late payments incur interest at 3% per month. Annual support fees are subject to 3% indexation per year. Disputed invoices must be raised in writing within 10 days of receipt.

ARTICLE 5 — SOFTWARE LICENSE TERMS

Axe Finance grants BankNorth Africa a perpetual, non-exclusive, non-transferable license to use the ACP software platform within the Client's own banking operations. The license covers unlimited internal users, all licensed modules, and future minor versions included within the maintenance scope. Major version upgrades are subject to separate commercial agreement.

Deployment Model: On-premise deployment at BankNorth Africa's data centers, with optional migration to cloud (Azure or AWS) subject to mutual agreement. Axe Finance is a certified Microsoft Azure Solution Partner.

Source Code Escrow: Axe Finance agrees to deposit ACP source code with an independent escrow agent. The Client may access the source code only in the event of Axe Finance's insolvency or cessation of support obligations.

ARTICLE 6 — IMPLEMENTATION METHODOLOGY AND QUALITY

Axe Finance shall implement ACP using its proprietary Agile Implementation Methodology, structured around 2-week sprints with continuous business validation. Each module go-live is preceded by a formal Phase Gate Review including functional testing, performance testing, security assessment, and user acceptance testing (UAT).

Axe Finance Team Composition: Program Director, 2 Senior ACP Consultants, 1 Technical Architect, 1 Data Migration Specialist, 1 Integration Engineer, 1 AI/Scoring Specialist, 1 Change Management Lead, and 1 PMO Coordinator.

Quality KPIs: On-time delivery rate target of 90%; defect density below 0.5 per 100 function points at go-live; system availability post-go-live at 99.9%; user adoption rate of 85% within 60 days of each go-live.

ARTICLE 7 — AI-POWERED LENDING CAPABILITIES

The ACP implementation includes Axe Finance's AI-powered lending capabilities comprising: machine learning credit scoring models calibrated on the Client's historical loan data; automated decision engines with configurable approval rules and delegation matrices; the ACP Early Warning System using AI to detect portfolio deterioration signals; and natural language processing for automated document analysis.

Axe Finance warrants that all AI models comply with applicable regulatory requirements on explainability and fairness. Model documentation including feature importance, validation results, and bias assessments will be delivered as part of each scoring module go-live.

ARTICLE 8 — SYSTEM INTEGRATION

ACP shall be integrated with the following Client systems: Core Banking System (CBS), Customer Relationship Management (CRM), Central Bank reporting systems, credit bureau interfaces (Experian, local bureau), document management system (DMS), and the Client's enterprise data warehouse.

Axe Finance has strong integration experience with major CBS platforms and will deliver integration specifications within 30 days of contract signature. API documentation, integration test environments, and technical onboarding will be provided within 15 days of project kickoff.

ARTICLE 9 — OBLIGATIONS OF BOTH PARTIES

Axe Finance obligations: Deliver all modules per the agreed timeline; maintain a dedicated senior team throughout the engagement; provide weekly delivery dashboards and monthly executive reports; ensure ACP achieves all agreed performance benchmarks; provide 5 years of corrective and evolutionary maintenance; ensure full compliance with ISO 27001 security standards throughout delivery; conduct structured knowledge transfer to ensure Client self-sufficiency.

BankNorth Africa (DAF) obligations: Make key business and IT decision-makers available within 48 hours for critical decisions; provide timely access to systems, data, and personnel; ensure infrastructure readiness per the technical prerequisites document; designate a Business Owner and IT Lead for each module; complete UAT sign-off within 10 business days of delivery; make payments strictly per the agreed schedule.

ARTICLE 10 — DATA PROTECTION AND SECURITY

Both parties shall comply with applicable data protection regulations including GDPR where applicable, the Tunisian data protection law, and all Central Bank of Tunisia cybersecurity directives. All customer data remains the exclusive property of BankNorth Africa. Axe Finance's ISO 27001 certification covers all delivery activities.

In case of security incident, Axe Finance must notify BankNorth Africa within 2 hours of detection and provide a full incident report within 24 hours. A Data Processing Agreement (DPA) is attached as Annex A.

ARTICLE 11 — INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The ACP platform, all underlying technology, methodologies, and pre-existing tools remain the exclusive intellectual property of Axe Finance. Custom developments, configurations, and parameterizations created specifically for BankNorth Africa become the property of BankNorth Africa upon full payment. BankNorth Africa receives a perpetual license to use all delivered configurations. Axe Finance may reference the engagement as a client reference with prior written approval.

ARTICLE 12 — SUPPORT AND MAINTENANCE

Support Hours: 24/7 for critical incidents; business hours (8:00–18:00 CET) for non-critical.

SLA Commitments: Critical incidents (system down): response within 1 hour, resolution within 4 hours. High priority: response within 4 hours, resolution within 1 business day. Medium priority: response within 1 business day, resolution within 5 business days.

Included in maintenance: Bug fixes and corrective patches; regulatory updates within 30 days of regulation publication; minor version upgrades; access to the Axe Finance customer portal.

ARTICLE 13 — LIABILITY AND PENALTIES

Delays exceeding 30 days per phase incur penalties of 0.5% of the phase value per week, capped at 10% of the phase value. Total Axe Finance liability for any single claim shall not exceed the total fees paid in the preceding 12 months. Neither party is liable for indirect damages, loss of profit, or consequential losses. Axe Finance indemnifies BankNorth Africa against third-party IP infringement claims arising from the ACP platform.

ARTICLE 14 — TERMINATION

Either party may terminate with 90 days written notice at a contract year-end. Immediate termination is permitted in case of insolvency, material breach unremedied within 30 days of written notice, or sustained SLA breach exceeding 3 consecutive months. Upon termination, Axe Finance delivers all Client data and configurations within 15 days. BankNorth Africa pays for all completed and accepted deliverables. The software license remains valid post-termination for modules already accepted and paid.

ARTICLE 15 — CONFIDENTIALITY

Both parties maintain strict confidentiality for 7 years post-contract on all information exchanged including technology architecture, business processes, financial data, and customer information. This obligation survives contract termination. Permitted disclosures are limited to regulatory requirements and court orders.

ARTICLE 16 — GOVERNING LAW AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

This contract is governed by French law. Disputes shall first be subject to 30-day good-faith negotiation between CEOs of both parties. Unresolved disputes are submitted to ICC arbitration in Paris, conducted in English, with a 3-arbitrator panel. The award is final, binding, and enforceable in all jurisdictions.

Signed in Paris, September 1, 2024

For Axe Finance SAS

Mehdi Tazi — Chief Executive Officer
Nadia Khelil — Chief Delivery Officer

For BankNorth Africa SA

Fatma Ouertani — Chief Financial Officer (DAF)

Signature

Signature